



ВАЗОРАТИ ҚОРҶОИ ХОРИҶӢ

ДАСТУРМАҲОИ МАҲФИР

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS

**Ministry of Foreign Affairs
REPUBLIC OF TAJIKISTAN**



BAZORATI KORHOI HORICHII CHUMHURI TOCHIKISTON MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS OF THE REPUBLIC OF TAJIKISTAN

Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principles

- Tajikistan will consider certain agreements with Uzbekistan regarding redefining borders, but Uzbekistan must be willing to fully recognize our border claims vis-à-vis Kyrgyzstan. Without open support from Uzbekistan on this issue, the delegation should consider it a **Red Line** regarding recognizing Uzbekistan's claims in the border dispute.
- The delegation should also pressure the Indian delegation to openly back our border claims in exchange for rejuvenating the economic and security partnership once vibrant between our two nations. It is a **Red Line** for continued economic and security partnerships if India won't openly commit to recognizing our sovereignty.
- It is a **Red Line** for Russian military personnel to serve as observers or peacekeepers of any kind within the borders of the Republic of Tajikistan and the delegation will immediately reject any Russian military presence as part of any such proposals. Other nations, including nations from outside the Central Asian region, will be considered for such a mission, but the Foreign Minister must approve any such agreement. Immediately report all details on any proposals to the foreign ministry and await guidance.

Principle Negotiation Positions

These positions are to be presented openly and publicly to all attendees. However, the delegation should pursue the specific items outlined below, either bilaterally or multilaterally, and should ensure Tajikistan's red lines are not crossed in any diplomatic agreements that might be presented, discussed, or aggressively pursued.

- We are open to formal dialogue regarding natural resources across Central Asia and is interested in working collaboratively with our neighboring nations to find optimal ways to use those resources to better the lives of all people in the region.
- We support economic integration and is open to proposals from neighboring nations regarding lowering trade barriers, increasing export of Tajik-made products (agricultural products, minerals, oil, and natural gas), and increasing imports from all nations in the region interested in free trade.
- We are open to Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) from all attendees at the summit and their economic partners as well. FDI opportunities will be considered on a case-by-case basis and the delegation should welcome proposals offered by any of the other six nations.

These positions are to be held by the Tajik delegation but should not be openly communicated except as outlined below.

- Our security is imperative. Hence, negotiation of security arrangements that support Tajikistan's inherent right to self-defense and maintenance of territorial integrity will be entertained. The delegation does not have authority to enter into binding agreements in this regard, but exploring possible security arrangements and broad points that might be part of such agreements acquired during the negotiations is strongly encouraged.
- We will not formally enter any intelligence sharing agreements with any nation attending the summit. However, if the People's Republic of China is willing to share intelligence on Kyrgyzstan or Uzbekistan, further dialogue on these points would be of interest. No discussions of these possibilities will take place except in bilateral discussions. This is a **Red Line**—no other nations can know about this initiative. Similarly, we consider Russia a declining power, and hence not a viable guarantor of security for the Tajik people within the CSTO. We are open to a more robust intelligence sharing agreement with India (pursuant to the earlier guidance), or China, which should be discussed only in bilateral negotiation with either party, or ideally only between heads of delegations. The delegation may not enter into any final agreements, but core platforms of any such agreement may be developed. Report findings back to the Foreign Minister.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted to the office of the Foreign Minister.

General: The delegation will work closely with and support the UN Special Representative of the Secretary-General's efforts to mediate this crisis. The delegation is directed to collect all available information about the negotiating positions of the other countries at the summit. Where possible, ascertain the other nation's flexible areas and try to bend the countries toward agreeing to Tajik interests. The end goal of this summit for Tajikistan is to reduce tensions and to return to the status quo regarding border demarcations and protection of Tajikistan's water resources. If incremental border adjustments can be made with Uzbekistan, which are supported by verifiable, confidence-building measures with neutral observers, this may be possible.

KAZAKHSTAN

Kazakhstan is a major player in the oil, natural gas, and mining sectors in our region. The Kazakhs have a natural, historical role in the region as both an economic hub and as a regional political leader. As the Russian-led CSTO is collapsing, and Armenia has paused their membership in the treaty, we are considering following suit, though that should not be made public in any way. That said, the foreign ministry is interested in learning if Kazakhstan is also considering leaving the CSTO. If so, the delegation should seek to understand if Kazakhstan is interested in entering a new, Central Asian-centered security arrangement. If they are, what are the concepts they would support for such a security arrangement, and which other nations in Central Asia, or outside of the region, do they see as potential partners in this concept? Report all findings to the Foreign Minister immediately and await guidance. Further, what economic partnerships might Kazakhstan entertain to bolster both our nations' economic opportunities? The more refined the information, the more valuable it will be for follow-on dialogue in bilateral negotiations later. The delegation

is directed to seek information on Kazakh-centered economic opportunities as a secondary, but nevertheless vital, part of the delegation's assignment as our representatives at the UN-supported summit. The PRC's Belt and Road Initiative offers many opportunities for partnered development with Kazakhstan.

KYRGYZSTAN

The Kyrgyz Republic has been our main antagonist regarding our border situation. However, the delegation is afforded leeway in seeking possible economic engagements with the Kyrgyz delegation. Additionally, should the Kyrgyz delegation be openly supportive of our positions vis-à-vis the other nations at the summit, the delegation is authorized to offer more generous economic partnerships with the Kyrgyz Republic. That said, we will not soften our stance on border demarcations with the Kyrgyz Republic. Confidence-building measures that might be created to stabilize the Kyrgyz-Tajik border situation would be acceptable, but no final agreement may be completed at this summit. Instead, the framework of a potential agreement is acceptable, assuming the Kyrgyz delegation agrees to the following:

- No military formations larger than platoon-sized assigned to any border outpost on the Kyrgyz-Tajik border.
- No military formations larger than battalion-sized assigned to any area within 25 kilometers of the Kyrgyz-Tajik border without officially informing our government about the deployment, the reason for the deployment, and how long the deployment will last.
- Acceptance by the Kyrgyz delegation of these same limitations on troop deployments and assignments by the Tajik military along the Kyrgyz-Tajik border areas, meaning reciprocity for both sides.

UZBEKISTAN

Uzbekistan is our other antagonist on border issues, but the government has fewer concerns about Uzbek efforts in this regard. Uzbekistan's border security is as important to them as it is to us, but they are far more willing, today, to concentrate on peaceful measures that are in pursuit of a permanent understanding. Uzbek warlords living in Tajikistan remain a troublesome reality but have not created problems in many years. Nevertheless, the delegation may not trade away Tajik territory with the Uzbek delegation as part of this summit. Theoretical discussions with the Uzbek delegation regarding how the border demarcation might be finalized are acceptable, but no final agreement may be completed at this summit. Gather Uzbek proposals, shape the discussion so that our territorial integrity is maintained to the greatest degree possible, and if the delegation can establish a viable framework, submit all information immediately to the Foreign Minister for further consideration and guidance. Uzbekistan is also the strongest economy in Central Asia, and the delegation is directed to pursue economic development opportunities with the Uzbek delegation to the greatest extent possible. All economic sectors are on the table, including environmental collaboration, educational exchanges, and technical exchanges in any sector of interest to the government of Uzbekistan. The delegation is also directed to approach Uzbekistan about crafting a regional security agreement that does not include the Russian Federation—meaning the end of the CSTO—but might include observers or

partners from outside the region. As part of these discussions, the head of delegation is authorized to engage directly and only with the head of the Uzbek delegation regarding purchase of excess Uzbek military equipment, and regarding the possibility of beginning combined military training exercises in the counterterrorism/counterinsurgency area as early as next year. Future combined training exercises covering other security areas should also be considered, and this combined training might include military, intelligence, and law enforcement units. No final agreements may be completed, but rather the framework for such agreements could be outlined for follow-on discussions between foreign ministers.

RUSSIA

The Russian Federation has an historical close affiliation for all Tajiks, but over time this relationship has floundered and is, perhaps, coming to an end. While the Russians are no longer a guarantor for our security and the CSTO is sundowning, despite Russian statements to the contrary, Russia still maintains a significant role in Central Asia. Economic initiatives that include Russia, but that do not place Russia in the driver's seat, are of interest to the Foreign Ministry. Tajiks working in Russia and sending remittances back home help families across Tajikistan and the delegation should seek to ensure this opportunity is not jeopardized during the summit. Additionally, Russian military observers or peacekeepers are not required nor desired as part of any confidence-building measures regarding the border demarcations between us and either Kyrgyzstan or Uzbekistan. Should any monitoring regime be proposed that includes Russian military forces, or other similar confidence-building measures be suggested by any nation, the delegation is directed to openly reject these proposals. Privately, in bilateral talks with the Russian delegation, the delegation should be magnanimous, even pleasant and encouraging to the Russians, but make no promises, agree to no proposals of any kind, and explain that you are not empowered to frame any agreements at this time. Regarding our long-term security, we need military equipment upgrades. Russian Federation military equipment has proven woefully inadequate throughout Russia's operations into Ukraine. The delegation is nevertheless directed to explore options for purchasing Russian military hardware at a significant discount, to include aircraft (fixed and rotary wing), armor, armored vehicles, artillery (including rocket artillery), communications, and electronic warfare equipment—which is, perhaps, the only Russian-made equipment that has proven successful in the Ukraine war. Seek information only, then report details back to the Foreign Ministry for later consultations with our Defense Ministry. Explain to the Russian delegation that any purchase agreements would need to be negotiated in a later bilateral meeting in Dushanbe. Finally, quietly raise the need for the Russian military forces based at Russia's 201st Military Base in Dushanbe to be redeployed back to the Russian Federation within the next two years. Thank the Russian delegation for their assistance in bolstering our security during the Afghan crisis, which has now abated.

PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA

The People's Republic of China has become our most important trading partner and the PRC's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) has dramatically improved and expanded our nation's infrastructure. The delegation is empowered to seek additional BRI projects that might continue to expand and enhance the China-Tajikistan relationship—specifically in our economic partnerships. Where possible, explore multilateral economic relationships between China, Kazakhstan, and Uzbekistan. Chinese technical assistance in water

resource management would be especially helpful in solving our water shortage crisis, but it must be made clear during bilateral-only meetings with the PRC delegation that water resources in Tajikistan must remain ours or be used in partnership with the other Central Asian nations as part of a natural resources management plan. Chinese technical assistance would be welcome, but the price tag must not be steep. Whereas Chinese technical assistance in economic sectors is desired, we are also interested in purchasing PLA equipment and the delegation is directed to explore this topic with the Chinese delegation during bilateral meetings. No final agreements may be drafted and agreed to, but framework agreements are authorized. Finally, Chinese intelligence, to include the Ministry of State Security, provincial, and certainly PLA intelligence, has become a powerful enabler for Chinese foreign policy and national security. The delegation is directed to explore, in bilateral-only, and strictly between heads of delegations, the idea of an intelligence exchange on threats to our national security, from internal subversive threats, but additionally from foreign penetrations of Tajikistan's national security apparatus. Report all opportunities in this regard to the Foreign Minister and await additional guidance.

INDIA

The Republic of India was one of Tajikistan's most important early supporters when the Soviet Union collapsed. This relationship remains important to our government and the delegation is directed to explore economic opportunities with India but be mindful of exposing such talks to the Chinese delegation as it is well known the PRC's BRI, which has significantly benefited us, might be curtailed in our nation if China learns of expanding trade relationships directly with India. Thus, be thoughtful and private in discussing these matters with the Indian delegation. India's open support for our border security and sovereign border claims would be helpful throughout this negotiation. Thus, seek support from India for their open acknowledgement of our claims, and for their steadfast support in maintaining those claims going forward. Much like our interest in Chinese and Russian arms, we are also interested in Indian-made arms. The delegation should approach the Indian delegation regarding possible arms sales. The full range of arms made by India, or their global partners are of interest to us. Once again, be thoughtful and private in discussing these matters.

There may be times when the Foreign Minister is unable to respond immediately to your communication. Under those circumstances, the delegation should proceed as directed in this guidance.